

6B Vocabulary extension

Passive verbs often in the news

- 1 The verbs in the box are often used in news stories. Organise them into groups which are similar in meaning. (Four of the groups should contain three verbs, one group should contain two verbs.) What is the difference between the verbs in each group?

to be damaged to be murdered to be burgled to be arrested to be killed to be wounded
to be robbed to be jailed to be assassinated to be injured to be stolen to be destroyed
to be hurt to be held

- 2 Circle the correct alternative in the following news stories.

- a "Several people were badly (1) *injured* / *wounded* and one was (2) *murdered* / *killed* when a bus crashed into a florist's this morning. The bus driver is being (3) *arrested* / *held* at a local police station for questioning. Witnesses say that he was driving at 60 miles an hour when the accident happened."
- b "Eight houses in the same street were (4) *burgled* / *stolen* in the space of one hour yesterday while all the residents of the street were at a garden party. Police believe that more than £100,000 worth of valuables were (5) *robbed* / *stolen*."
- c "The family of Geri Baines, who was (6) *assassinated* / *murdered* by her ex-husband a year ago, were angry today when they heard that he had only been (7) *arrested* / *jailed* for eight years, following a psychiatrist's report."
- d "Over 80 paintings were completely (8) *damaged* / *destroyed* in a fire at the City Art Gallery last night. Another 120 paintings were quite badly (9) *damaged* / *destroyed* by smoke and will need very careful restoration."

- 3 Match the following headlines with a newspaper article below. Then complete the gaps with the correct form of a verb from Exercise 1.

- Wigs lead police to prisoners
- Hairdresser's final cut
- Popstar loses hair

1

Two people were slightly (1) and equipment was badly (2) when a hairdresser, Mari Clarke, 23, went 'crazy' with a pair of scissors in a high-street salon yesterday. Manageress Jacqui Reeves said: 'I feel sorry for Mari. She's been very depressed since her boyfriend was (3) for three years for armed robbery.' Ms Clark is being (4) for questioning by police.

2

Multi-millionaire popstar Frankie Vale came home from a tour of Europe last night to find that his house had been (5) and his collection of valuable antique wigs had been (6) Tapes of his new album, which comes out next week, were also (7) – pieces of plastic and tape were left all over the floor. 'This was done by someone who is jealous of me, and I know who it is,' said Frankie.

3

Two men who escaped from Winkfield prison last week dressed as women were (8) at Manchester Airport yesterday afternoon. Police were alerted when a nearby supermarket was (9) by two 'women' – as one of them was escaping 'her' blonde wig came off. A shop assistant was slightly (10) when she was pushed to the floor by one of the escaped prisoners.

- 4 Write a news story using the passive verbs in Exercise 1 for one of the following headlines.

- Flood chaos hits London
- Mass-murderer dies
- Football fans in fight
- Burglars robbed

6A Passive dominoes

Passive forms

... been described as the greatest actor ever.	In Britain, 28 million letters are ...	... delivered every day.	My car is ...
... being repaired at the moment.	<i>Hamlet</i> was ...	... written by William Shakespeare.	The tickets will all be ...
... sold before we get there.	Twenty-seven people were ...	... arrested after the match.	When we arrived, the children were ...
... being put to bed.	Dogs must be ...	... kept on a lead while in the park.	Three hundred people have been ...
... killed by an earthquake in China.	John's in hospital, but he's ...	... being looked after very well.	Quick, get a doctor! She's ...
... been shot!	The meeting will be ...	... held next Tuesday.	Fifteen people are ...
... known to have survived the explosion.	I don't believe it! My car has ...	... been stolen!	Old people shouldn't be ...
... left on their own.	If the police catch you, you'll ...	... be sent to prison.	The staff are going to be ...
... told about it at today's meeting.	I went inside although I had ...	... been told to wait in the corridor.	<i>Jurassic Park</i> was ...
... directed by Steven Spielberg.	All bags must be ...	... checked before entering the building.	A lot of coffee is ...
... produced in Brazil.	Purchases cannot be ...	... exchanged without a receipt.	I took some photos of him while he was ...
... being interviewed.	When I was a child, I used to be ...	... sent to bed early if I was naughty.	Marlon Brando has ...